PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | CrowdStrike | Microsoft Sentinel | Cloud Security | CISSP

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, deploying, and operating enterprise-grade security solutions across hybrid cloud and on-premise environments. In my current role at the University of the Arts, London (UAL), I lead the engineering and operational delivery of a multi-platform security stack covering Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Privileged Access Management (PAM), vulnerability management, and identity security for an estate of 8,000 users. I bring deep technical expertise in CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender (for Endpoint, Identity, and Microsoft 365), and Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID. I combine strong detection engineering skills with hands-on security architecture experience, scripting and automation in PowerShell, and a thorough understanding of industry frameworks including NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, and MITRE ATT&CK. I hold eligibility for UK security clearance and am available for hybrid roles requiring regular City of London presence.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint and Detection:** CrowdStrike Falcon (Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, detection rule engineering, threat hunting
- **SIEM and SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL detections, workbooks, Logic Apps playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk / Search Processing Language (SPL); Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) workflow design and automation
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure AD / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus; risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Cloud and Infrastructure Security:** Microsoft Azure, hybrid cloud architectures, Microsoft Intune / Mobile Device Management (MDM) / Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium
- **Network and Email Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast email security
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting for security automation, SOAR playbook development, API integrations
- **Incident Response:** Full lifecycle incident management under NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detections, digital forensics support
- **Frameworks and Compliance:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Architect and maintain the enterprise security engineering stack for an 8,000-user hybrid environment, integrating CrowdStrike Falcon, Microsoft Sentinel, Microsoft Defender XDR (Extended Detection and Response), BeyondTrust PAM, and Tenable.io into a unified, layered defence posture.
- Engineer KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike NG-SIEM aligned to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, improving detection coverage and reducing false positive rates across endpoint, identity, and cloud telemetry.
- Design and deploy SOAR automation playbooks to streamline incident triage, containment actions, and user notification, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) for high-volume alert categories.

- Lead the security engineering design for identity controls in Azure AD / Entra ID, including Conditional Access policy authoring, Privileged Identity Management (PIM) configuration, and MFA enforcement across all user populations.
- Manage the vulnerability management lifecycle using Pentera BAS, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, directing risk-based remediation and reporting posture metrics to senior leadership.
- Own the CrowdStrike Falcon platform engineering including policy configuration, sensor deployment at scale, EDR tuning, and integration with SIEM and SOAR workflows.
- Collaborate with infrastructure and cloud teams to integrate security controls into Azure workloads, reviewing architecture proposals and ensuring new services meet security standards before deployment.
- Lead incident response from initial detection through to root cause analysis and lessons learned, producing post-incident reports and driving preventive control improvements.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 - March 2025*

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Supported the engineering deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) across 8,000 devices, configuring detection policies, onboarding endpoints, and validating coverage against defined threat scenarios.
- Monitored and investigated security alerts in Microsoft Sentinel and Microsoft Defender XDR, triaging events, correlating log data, and escalating confirmed incidents with structured investigation notes.
- Contributed to Conditional Access policy design and BeyondTrust PAM configuration, reducing privileged account risk and improving identity security posture across the estate.
- Developed PowerShell automation scripts for security operations tasks including IOC blocking, account remediation, and compliance reporting, reducing manual effort across repeated workflows.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus and AppCheck, coordinating remediation with application, network, and infrastructure owners to meet agreed SLA targets.
- Supported Cyber Essentials Plus annual assessments, identifying and remediating control gaps and contributing to the ongoing compliance programme.
- Maintained and improved security runbooks and playbooks for common incident types, aligning response steps to NIST 800-61 and MITRE ATT&CK.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 - March 2022*

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / Financial Technology)

- Designed and implemented security controls for a SaaS FinTech platform including endpoint security, network monitoring, identity management, and patch management across cloud and on-premise infrastructure.
- Led ISO 27001 compliance activities including risk assessments, control gap analysis, and evidence collection to support certification and ongoing audit readiness.
- Managed network segmentation, access management, and security hardening for development and production environments supporting the core SaaS product.
- Authored and maintained security policies, incident response procedures, and operational runbooks aligned to ISO 27001 and NIST CSF.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and engineered the full CrowdStrike Falcon platform deployment at UAL, covering NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, and Discover modules across 8,000 endpoints, delivering unified visibility across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry.
- Led the enterprise-wide Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) rollout across 8,000 devices, becoming UAL's primary subject matter expert for Microsoft Defender XDR and driving integration with Sentinel for correlated detection and response.
- Engineered a library of MITRE ATT&CK-aligned KQL detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel, closing detection gaps across 14 key tactics and improving the security team's ability to identify and contain threats before escalation.
- Introduced Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS) to continuously validate security control effectiveness, enabling evidence-based risk reporting to the Chief Information Security Officer (CISO) and board.
- Built SOAR automation in Microsoft Sentinel that reduced analyst time on repetitive phishing and credential-abuse triage by automating initial response actions, freeing the team to focus on complex investigations.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus certification across UAL's estate, passing annual external assessments and driving continuous improvement of technical controls.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)